

SnowPro Advanced: Administrator — Prep Guide

⚠️ **Verify against the official exam guide as of July 2026** — Snowflake revises exam codes, domains, and weightings periodically. Confirm current details at snowflake.com/certifications before your exam.

PJ's Academy · Prove you can run Snowflake at enterprise scale.

The Administrator exam (ADA-C01) validates that you can manage accounts, security, cost, performance, and data protection across an organization's Snowflake estate.

Prerequisite: SnowPro Core certified.

Exam At A Glance

Item	Detail
Exam code	ADA-C01
Questions	~65
Duration	115 minutes
Cost	\$375 USD
Prerequisite	SnowPro Core

Domain Weightings

#	Domain	Weight
1	Snowflake Security & Governance	30%
2	Account Management & Data Governance	25%
3	Performance & Cost Management	25%
4	Data Protection, DR & Sharing	20%

Domain 1 — Security & Governance (30%)

- **RBAC administration** — role hierarchies, functional vs access roles, `MANAGE GRANTS`, future grants.
- **User & session management** — `CREATE USER`, session policies, session timeouts.
- **Authentication** — SSO/SAML, SCIM provisioning, MFA enforcement, key-pair rotation.
- **Network security** — network policies, network rules, PrivateLink.
- **Governance** — masking policies, row access policies, tags, tag-based masking, object dependencies.

- **ACCESS_HISTORY** & **LOGIN_HISTORY** for auditing.

```
-- Future grants: auto-grant on new objects in a schema
GRANT SELECT ON FUTURE TABLES IN SCHEMA analytics.public TO ROLE reporter;
-- Session policy
CREATE SESSION POLICY strict_policy SESSION_IDLE_TIMEOUT_MINS = 30;
```

Domain 2 — Account Management & Data Governance (25%)

- **Organizations** — ORGADMIN, creating accounts, cross-region/cloud.
- **Resource monitors** — org & account level, credit quotas, triggers.
- **Parameters** — account/session/object parameter hierarchy.
- **ACCOUNT_USAGE** vs **ORGANIZATION_USAGE** schemas.
- **Replication & data governance** across accounts.

Domain 3 — Performance & Cost Management (25%)

- **Warehouse administration** — sizing, multi-cluster scaling policies (Standard vs Economy), auto-suspend/resume.
- **Cost attribution** — chargeback via ACCOUNT_USAGE, resource monitors, budgets.
- **Query performance** — Query Profile, clustering, search optimization, materialized views.
- **Warehouse utilization** — `WAREHOUSE_LOAD_HISTORY`, queuing, spilling.
- **Storage cost** — Time Travel/Fail-safe retention, transient tables.

```
-- Find idle-but-expensive warehouses
SELECT warehouse_name, SUM(credits_used) c
FROM SNOWFLAKE.ACCOUNT_USAGE.WAREHOUSE_METERING_HISTORY
WHERE start_time > DATEADD(day, -30, CURRENT_DATE())
GROUP BY 1 ORDER BY c DESC;
```

Domain 4 — Data Protection, DR & Sharing (20%)

- **Time Travel & Fail-safe** administration, retention tuning.
- **Replication & failover groups** — DR design, RPO/RTO.
- **Cloning** for backup/dev strategies.
- **Secure Data Sharing** administration — shares, reader accounts, Data Exchange.
- **Encryption** — key rotation, Tri-Secret Secure, customer-managed keys.

High-Yield Facts

- **Future grants** auto-apply privileges to objects created later — key admin tool.
- **Economy** scaling policy conserves credits (fuller clusters) vs **Standard** (faster).
- **ORGADMIN** manages the organization & creates accounts.
- **ORGANIZATION_USAGE** aggregates usage across all accounts.
- **Resource monitors** can act at account OR warehouse level with NOTIFY/SUSPEND triggers.
- **Session policies** enforce idle timeouts; **network policies** restrict IPs.

Practice Questions (10)

- Q1.** Which auto-grants privileges on objects created later in a schema? A) GRANT ... ON ALL B) GRANT ... ON FUTURE C) MANAGE GRANTS D) ROLE inheritance
- Q2.** Which scaling policy conserves credits by filling clusters? A) Standard B) Economy C) Auto D) Maximized
- Q3.** Which role manages the organization and creates accounts? A) ACCOUNTADMIN B) ORGADMIN C) SECURITYADMIN D) SYSADMIN
- Q4.** Cross-account usage is aggregated in: A) ACCOUNT_USAGE B) ORGANIZATION_USAGE C) INFORMATION_SCHEMA D) PUBLIC
- Q5.** A resource monitor can act at which levels? A) Account only B) Warehouse only C) Account and warehouse D) Query only
- Q6.** Which view audits who accessed which columns? A) LOGIN_HISTORY B) ACCESS_HISTORY C) QUERY_HISTORY D) COPY_HISTORY
- Q7.** For non-Snowflake data consumers, admins create: A) A share only B) A reader account C) A clone D) A stage
- Q8.** Which enforces a 30-minute idle logout? A) Network policy B) Session policy C) Masking policy D) Row policy
- Q9.** To restrict access to specific IP ranges: A) Session policy B) Network policy C) Masking D) Tag
- Q10.** Replicating account objects for DR uses: A) Replication group B) Failover group C) Clone D) Share

✓ **Answers**

1-B · 2-B · 3-B · 4-B · 5-C · 6-B · 7-B · 8-B · 9-B · 10-B



3-Week Plan

- **Week 1:** Security & governance (RBAC, policies, auditing).
- **Week 2:** Account mgmt + performance/cost.
- **Week 3:** DR/sharing + practice tests.

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